



ZENITH RISK TREND REPORT

2025 Healthcare Risk Trends

Five planning themes for employers and advisors navigating high-cost claims, specialty therapies, volatility, and renewal pressure.

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The central 2025 theme is concentration of risk

A small number of severe or complex claims can shape an entire plan year, making early visibility and coordinated response increasingly important.

Five planning themes

- High-cost claim concentration
- Specialty pharmacy and advanced therapies
- Greater need for clinical coordination
- Volatility-sensitive stop-loss strategy
- Demand for transparent renewal logic

How to use this report

These themes are a strategic planning framework, not an actuarial forecast. Employers should evaluate them against their own population, claims, contracts, and risk tolerance.

The priority is not predicting every severe claim. It is building a system that responds intelligently when risk emerges.

Claim severity and specialty therapies require contract-level attention

The financial impact of a complex case depends on clinical pathways, pharmacy terms, provider access, and stop-loss contract language.

Review high-cost claim readiness

- Notification and case-management workflows
- Centers of excellence and specialty networks
- Specific-deductible and laser provisions
- Run-out and reimbursement procedures

Review pharmacy readiness

- Contract definitions and rebate treatment
- Specialty-drug sourcing
- Utilization and clinical review
- Gene and cell therapy provisions

The most expensive claim is also an operational event. Clinical and financial teams need one response plan.

Renewal strategy must separate signal from short-term noise

One difficult year can produce reactive decisions. A multi-year lens helps distinguish structural risk from temporary variance.

Questions for the experience review

- Which claims are ongoing?
 - Which costs were one-time?
 - What interventions changed future exposure?
 - How did vendors perform?
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Questions for the financing review

- Is the specific deductible still appropriate?
- Would a pooled or captive layer improve alignment?
- How should collateral and cash flow be modeled?
- What evidence supports the renewal narrative?

Turn the trends into a focused planning agenda

A practical 2025 response connects information, clinical action, contract review, and financing decisions.

01

Improve visibility

Create a timely view of high-cost claims, pharmacy exposure, and vendor actions.

02

Clarify ownership

Assign decision-makers for clinical escalation, contracting, and reimbursement.

03

Review contracts

Test stop-loss, pharmacy, TPA, and network terms against actual operating needs.

01

Model alternatives

Compare retention, pooling, and captive structures using realistic scenarios.

02

Build the renewal story

Present the plan's risks, actions, and forward strategy with evidence.

Use the report as a conversation starter with Zenith's underwriting and strategy team.